

it is a hand movement on a bicycle or a flashing light on a motorized vehicle, the signal tells the world what you intend to do, enabling other drivers to avoid accidents *and* more easily accommodate your desires.

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5. Wave.
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A friendly wave accomplishes two things: 1) says hello, and 2) shows that you acknowledge another person's presence. A cycling buddy waves at cars with drivers who pass carefully and patiently wait at intersections. I have adopted his habit and feel that I have joined a cadre of cycling ambassadors.

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6. Tell someone what others think of them.
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Make sure it's pleasant and accurate. A kind word can change someone's perspective and help forge or reinforce friendships.

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7. Wait up.
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Having been waited on and having waited for others, I can say that a slower pace can mean more meaningful conversations. There are times, though, that I have asked others to go ahead and wait for me at the finish line.

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8. Return things you've borrowed.
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Just because the lender hasn't asked for it back doesn't mean it wouldn't be appreciated to have it back.

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9. Respond promptly to invitations.
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It's okay to say "no" but please do it as quickly as possible.

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10. Say "please" and "thank you."
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Another thing that is underused but highly valuable.

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11. Be sensitive.
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Just because you have parents to watch your kids while you go to dinner or spend a weekend away; plenty of money for vacations each year; family members with no medical issues; a great career in a profession widely respected—doesn't mean everyone else does.

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12. Call or email the parents of your teenagers' friends if you have something important to say.
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Even the best-raised kids and most well-intentioned parents aren't perfect